



Chad Ballard <freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com>

Lot10 questions

8 messages

Chad Ballard <freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 24, 2026 at 8:05 AM

To: Darren Burke <Burkebuilder@gmail.com>

Hey Darren.

I know you had mentioned some questions on the bill for your house. If you wanted to discuss any of that just let me know. Thanks

Chad

Sent from my iPhone

Darren Burke <burkebuilder@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 24, 2026 at 5:49 PM

To: Chad Ballard <freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com>

Hey Chad,

I'm sorry for the delay on this email and the analysis. I'll try and make it more brief than I was going to for the sake of time and simplicity. I had budgeted our person house based on the pricing of Lot 6 Marrin because you wired it in March, which was only four months prior to our house

I'm also looking at the pricing for the upcoming house at Lot 16, which of course has not yet been wired. There are many elements of these homes that you have priced the same as ours, but there are some items in our house that you have charged more to us than you have at these two spec homes, one of which has not yet been wired.

Here are the items you have charged more for at our house vs these homes:

Three car garage

10 Marrin \$1250

6 Marrin \$950

Difference +\$300

400 amp service

10 Marrin \$1800

6 Marrin \$1500

16 Marrin \$1500

Difference +\$300

Flood lights

10 Marrin \$200 each

6 Marrin \$150 each

16 Marrin \$150 each

Difference +\$250 (for 5)

Unfinished Basement

10 Marrin \$950 for 740sf unfinished area (other is finished and paid as such)

6 Marrin \$1100 for 2542 unfinished area

16 Marrin \$1000 for 1732sf

It seems \$950 is high for only the 740sf unfinished in our house, given the other homes basements are much larger at only \$50 and \$150 more cost. How do you feel about \$600 for the unfinished basement at our house for a difference of \$350?

Basement wall mounted fan

No big deal, it appears you are charging the same to hard wire a fan that we'll hang on the wall (I will mount) as that of installing a ceiling fan. Would \$75 be fair to wire the wall fan and provide the wire? It would be a difference of \$75

Temp poles

You noted that you had (3) temp pole permits. I thought there were (2) due to Duke Energy's situation? A difference of \$75 (but maybe not)

Square Footage

This doesn't pertain to the other homes, but my draftsman did make a mistake in his calculations on the square footage key. I emailed him and brought this to his attention. He found that there was a discrepancy in both the upstairs SF and the main level SF. The main level went up, but the upstairs went down in size. He doesn't know how that happened, but I have attached the new key after he made corrections.

So now, the square footages are:

Main 2678

Second 1318

Bonus 484 (but I will break this out separately below)

Basement 1517

Total 5997

As you can imagine, a dishonest person would only point out that the upstairs SF went down and not mention that the main level went up. I can't bring myself to be that way, so I'm certainly going to be honest and point out the main level went up, which now pays you more for that level. The overall cost would come down slightly to this:

6030sf - 5997 = 33sf x \$5 = a **Difference of \$165**

Unfinished bonus room

We were going to leave this completely unfinished, but we figured it may be better long term to have it heated and cooled, so we figured to finish it. We're paying additionally for the LED wafer lights, so all that's left in that room are 5 plugs. If you figure 184 x \$5, that's \$920 for 5 plugs. I know we could go throughout the house figuring it that way, but it wouldn't make sense because some rooms have a lot of wiring where others don't.

For this 184sf room, my hope is that you will charge \$85 per plug x 5 plus for a total of \$425 (so about half). It will be the only room I ask for like this. It would be a difference of \$495 in the overall SF price of the house.

Considering my budget was based on your pricing to me for Lots 6 and Lot 16, my proposal to you asks for the same pricing as those homes as reflected in this email. Here is a cumulative total of what I have laid out:

A total difference of \$2,010.00

I didn't have you quote our home because I felt like I had a perfect model of pricing based on these two homes (lots 6 and 16), one of which you had just wired and the other you will be wiring after my house. We can talk tomorrow if that's a good time for you. I need to help my brother with something for my mom tonight.

Thank you Chad,

Darren Burke
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Flood lights

10 Marrin \$200 each

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I didn't realize I had these off by \$50. I will honor the \$150 price for remaining of the year and credit the \$250

Credit \$250

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Yes that is fine with me.
Credit \$75

Temp poles

You noted that you had (3) temp pole permits. I thought there were (2) due to Duke Energy's situation? **A difference of \$75** (but maybe not)

Yes only two temp pole permits, the third permit will be when we get you set up for temp power on the house and that permit is \$75 as well.

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For this 184sf room, my hope is that you will charge \$85 per plug x 5 plus for a total of \$425 (so about half). It will be the only room I ask for like this. It would be a difference of \$495 in the overall SF price of the house.

This room does have only 5 plugs and also switch for the lights. It also has a light in each storage hole that I didn't charge for this time. Normally \$50 each. I will honor the \$85 per plug x 5 but will also charge for the switch at \$85, I think that will be fair.

Credit \$410

Considering my budget was based on your pricing to me for Lots 6 and Lot 16, my proposal to you asks for the same pricing as those homes as reflected in this email. Here is a cumulative total of what I have laid out:

A total difference of \$2,010.00

Also the rough in bill was \$32,495.50 and the check paid was \$30,115.50. That's a \$2380 difference instead of \$2010. Maybe we are still missing something else?

With my credits given

- \$150
-\$300
-\$250
-\$200
-\$75
-\$165
-\$410

Total - \$1550

If my math is correct then it should be \$2380 - \$1550 in credits, \$830 still owed for rough in?

Double check everything and let me know what you think and if I'm off on anything. I apologize for being off on a few items. Pricing is the hardest part because I want to make everyone happy but also know that I'm trying my best to run a successful business as I know you are as well! We can talk tomorrow about anything else if you want. Thanks

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To: Chad Ballard <freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com>

Tue, Aug 25, 2026 at 11:22 PM

Hey Chad,

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Thank you for working with me on the pricing. I appreciate the explanation of each category. I'll send you the check for the difference tomorrow. I had held back the \$2300 before I took more time to compare all the categories.

I hope wiring does not continue to increase. If this inflation does not turn around, housing will continue to slow to a crawl. Even though we're busy, we've seen sales slow down since the tariffs and war started. We've gotten letters from vendors saying they have raised prices due to these elements.

Thanks again and I'll see you soon,

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To: Darren Burke <burkebuilder@gmail.com>

Wed, Aug 26, 2026 at 1:21 PM

Sounds good. Thanks Darren! I'm trying to do my best on my prices. I really do enjoy doing your work and very appreciative of the work!!

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On Aug 25, 2026, at 11:22 PM, Darren Burke <burkebuilder@gmail.com> wrote:

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Difference	<u>+\$300</u>

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Bonus 484 (but I will break this out
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Basement 1517

Total 5997

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myself to be that way, so I'm certainly going to be

honest and point out the main level went up, which now pays you more for that level. The overall cost would come down slightly to this:

6030sf - 5997 = 33sf x \$5 = a **Difference of \$165**

Credit \$165

Unfinished bonus room

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For this 184sf room, my hope is that you will charge \$85 per plug x 5 plus for a total of \$425 (so about half). It will be the only room I ask for like this. It would be a difference of \$495 in the overall SF price of the house.

This room does have only 5 plugs and also switch for the lights. It also has a light in each storage hole that I didn't charge for this time. Normally \$50 each. I will honor the \$85 per plug x 5 but will also charge for the switch at \$85, I think that will be fair.

Credit \$410

Considering my budget was based on your pricing to me for Lots 6 and Lot 16, my proposal to you asks for the same pricing as those homes as reflected in this email. Here is a cumulative total of what I have laid out:

A total difference of \$2,010.00

Also the rough in bill was \$32,495.50 and the check paid was \$30,115.50. That's a \$2380 difference instead of \$2010. Maybe we are still missing something else?

With my credits given

- \$150
-\$300
-\$250
-\$200
-\$75
-\$165
-\$410

Total - \$1550

If my math is correct then it should be \$2380 - \$1550 in credits, \$830 still owed for rough in?

Double check everything and let me know what you think and if I'm off on anything. I apologize for being off on a few items. Pricing is the hardest part because I want to make everyone happy but also know that I'm trying my best to run a successful business as I know you are as well! We can talk tomorrow about anything else if you want. Thanks

On Aug 24, 2026, at 8:05 AM, Chad Ballard
<freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com> wrote:

Hey Darren.

I know you had mentioned some questions on the bill for your house. If you wanted to discuss any of that just let me know. Thanks

Chad

Sent from my iPhone

Darren Burke <burkebuilder@gmail.com>
To: Chad Ballard <freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com>

Mon, Aug 31, 2026 at 8:01 PM

Hey Chad,

I'm catching up on bills. I'm printing a check for the difference of \$830.00 and I'll drop it in the mail tomorrow. Sorry for the delay!

I'm going to send you a separate email about starting the final at Gus house.

Thanks Chad,

Darren Burke
Darren Burke Construction Co., Inc.
(336) 399-6541
burkebuilder@gmail.com
www.dburkehomes.com

On Aug 25, 2026, at 11:22 PM, Darren Burke <burkebuilder@gmail.com> wrote:

Hey Chad,

It's been a very busy past couple of days after coming back from a week off. Thank you for the detailed email addressing the pricing. I found your emailed quote for our house, which I had stored in the wrong folder. After reading through it, I recall our discussion about you going up to \$6/SF and some of the itemized costs. I think I didn't refer back to it because I had set our budget up on the homes at Lot 6 and Lot 16. I suppose my thinking was that you had agreed to wire our home based on pricing you gave for those two.

Thank you for working with me on the pricing. I appreciate the explanation of each category. I'll send you the check for the difference tomorrow. I had held back the \$2300 before I took more time to compare all the categories.

I hope wiring does not continue to increase. If this inflation does not turn around, housing will continue to slow to a crawl. Even though we're busy, we've seen sales slow down since the tariffs and war started. We've gotten letters from venders saying they have raised prices due to these elements.

Thanks again and I'll see you soon,

Darren Burke
Darren Burke Construction Co., Inc
336.399.6541
www.dburkehomes.com

On Aug 24, 2026, at 10:35 PM, Chad Ballard <freedomfamilyelectric@gmail.com> wrote:

Hey Darren.

I'm just going to include your email so I can just respond to each part as I go. Also I did quote your house back in April which had those prices listed on the quote that way you would have an estimate on everything. I can send if needed. With the garage price at \$1250, I have done some math and got my prices on everything and realized the time and money I put into a garage for only \$950 I'm basically wiring it for free. Due to that I went up to \$1250 as a minimum. I might have to even make more adjustments to that sometime in 2027, tbd. Also I have had a price increase on all of my material not just wire, everything is up about 10% for me right now. One reason for 400 amp at \$1800 but I will honor \$1500. That's why I have mentioned price per foot going up to cover most of the prices. But the quote on lot 16 will remain what I quoted unless they decide to add anything.

Sent from my iPad

Three car garage

10 Marrin	\$1250
6 Marrin	\$950
Difference	<u>+\$300</u>

If I credit much I'm basically even. What if I split it?
Credit \$150

400 amp service

10 Marrin	\$1800
6 Marrin	\$1500
16 Marrin	\$1500
Difference	<u>+\$300</u>

Credit \$300

Flood lights

10 Marrin	\$200 each
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6 Marrin \$150 each

16 Marrin \$150 each

Difference **+\$250 (for 5)**

I didn't realize I had these off by \$50. I will honor the \$150 price for remaining of the year and credit the \$250

Credit \$250

Unfinished Basement

10 Marrin \$950 for 740sf unfinished area (other is finished and paid as such)

6 Marrin \$1100 for 2542 unfinished area

16 Marrin \$1000 for 1732sf

I know your basement is smaller on the unfinished side but I also included a lot more than normal. I did about 5 plugs extra at no charge and I also ran an opener circuit for the basement garage door at no charge. Basements are similar to the garage and after everything really no profit. I can credit a partial back of \$200

It seems \$950 is high for only the 740sf unfinished in our house, given the other homes basements are much larger at only \$50 and \$150 more cost. How do you feel about \$600 for the unfinished basement at our house for a **difference of \$350?**

Credit \$200

Basement wall mounted fan

No big deal, it appears you are charging the same to hard wire a fan that we'll hang on the wall (I will mount) as that of installing a ceiling fan. Would \$75 be fair to wire the wall fan and provide the wire? It would be a **difference of \$75**

Yes that is fine with me.
Credit \$75

Temp poles

You noted that you had (3) temp pole permits. I thought there were (2) due to Duke Energy's situation? **A difference of \$75** (but maybe not)

Yes only two temp pole permits, the third permit will be when we get you set up for temp power on the house and that permit is \$75 as well.

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Credit \$410

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